

DIPLOMATIC WORKING DOCUMENT

# Stability First Enhanced Accord

*A Deferred-Sequencing Framework for US-Iran Stabilization,  
Strait of Hormuz Governance, and Nuclear Resolution*

*Calibrated for the 14-Point MoU and 30-Day Deferred Window*

Version 1.0 | May 2026

Drawing from: Hormuz First Enhanced Accord v2.0 | RCSA Simplified Edition 2026

RCSA v3.6 Final Diplomatic Edition | Modular Hormuz Solutions Annex v1.0

Modular Nuclear Solutions Annex 1.0 | Stability First Accord v1.0 (Precedent)

FOR AUTHORIZED NEGOTIATORS

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## Preamble: The Nuclear-Deferred Breakthrough

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*"The single most important achievement is the agreement that Iran will never ever have nuclear material that will create a bomb."*

-- Omani Foreign Minister Badr Albusaidi, May 2026

### The May 2026 Moment

As of May 8, 2026, the United States and the Islamic Republic of Iran stand at the closest point to a durable agreement since hostilities began on February 28, 2026. After weeks of deadlock under a strictly "Nuclear First" framework -- demanding that Iran export its uranium stockpile as a prerequisite to any ceasefire -- negotiators have achieved a breakthrough. The 14-point Memorandum of Understanding, mediated by Pakistan and negotiated by Trump's envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner, adopts a **deferred sequencing** model: ending the active war and reopening the Strait of Hormuz immediately, while moving the complex nuclear technicalities into a **30-day negotiation period**.

This document, the **Stability First Enhanced Accord**, is designed to fill that window with a complete, ready-to-implement architecture that reflects the real-world diplomatic trajectory confirmed by reporting from *Axios*, *The Wall Street Journal*, *CNN*, and multiple official sources on May 7-8, 2026.

### Why This Moment Is Different

- US gasoline prices have reached \$4.53 per gallon nationally (\$6+ in California), creating domestic urgency for resolution.
- Project Freedom (the US Navy Hormuz escort operation, launched May 4) was paused on May 6, signaling a definitive shift from military to diplomatic pressure.
- Iran has conditionally indicated willingness to transfer its highly enriched uranium stockpile out of the country -- a position it rejected as recently as April 2026.
- Both sides have implicitly accepted Pakistan as primary mediator and acknowledge the dual blockade cannot continue.
- The approaching Hajj pilgrimage (~May 25) creates a hard deadline where escalation carries severe political costs.

- A 40-nation European coalition (led by France's *Charles de Gaulle* carrier) is forming, providing multilateral legitimacy for joint Hormuz governance.
- Iran has formed a new Bureau of Persian Gulf Strait for managing earnings from taxed ships passing through Hormuz Strait, signaling institutional preparation for a post-war governance regime.

## The Transition to Deferred Sequencing

### The "Nuclear First" Stance (April 2026)

Throughout April and the initial talks in Islamabad, the US position was "zero enrichment" and the immediate removal of all nuclear material before lifting any sanctions. US Secretary of State Marco Rubio publicly stated: "They could have [a civilian nuclear program] if that's what they wanted, but they're not acting like that's what they wanted." This all-or-nothing approach led to the "unyielding" deadlock President Trump described on April 11.

### The "Nuclear-Deferred" Shift (May 3-8)

Following the failure of the all-or-nothing approach, the new 14-point MoU -- mediated by Pakistan -- adopts the "Hormuz First" logic that this framework has championed since its inception. It prioritizes ending the military conflict and reopening the Strait of Hormuz immediately, while moving the complex nuclear technicalities into the 30-day negotiation period.

#### How the 14-Point MoU Sequences the Issues

According to reports from *Axios* and *The Wall Street Journal* (May 7-8, 2026), the framework is now divided into two distinct timeframes:

##### Immediate Action (Stage 1, Days 1-14):

- Declaration of an end to the war ("Operation Epic Fury")
- Lifting of the naval blockade and reopening the Strait of Hormuz
- Initial release of billions in frozen Iranian funds (mirroring the "pilot asset releases")
- Commitment to a moratorium on enrichment (framework agreed; specifics deferred)

##### The 30-Day Window (Stage 2, Days 15-44):

- Negotiating the specifics of the 12-to-15-year moratorium on enrichment
- Finalizing the logistics for exporting the highly enriched uranium (HEU) stockpile
- Agreeing on "snap" inspections and protocols for underground facilities (Natanz/Fordow)
- Comprehensive sanctions relief architecture

### Why the Change?

This shift to a deferred model is being hailed as the "breakthrough" because it allows both sides to claim an immediate win:

- **For the U.S.:** It ends the energy crisis caused by the Hormuz blockade and secures a binding commitment to export the HEU within the 30-day window.
- **For Iran:** It stops the bombing and provides immediate economic relief through asset returns before finalizing the permanent nuclear concessions.

The fact that the world's negotiators landed on this "30-day deferred window" -- decoupling the immediate "shooting war" from the long-term "nuclear file" -- confirms that deferred sequencing is the only viable path out of the conflict.

### What This Document Is

Table 1: Source Document Integration

| Source Document                     | What It Contributes                                                           |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Stability First Accord v1.0         | Precedent framework; three-stage timeline; modular architecture               |
| Hormuz First Enhanced Accord v2.0   | Deferred-sequencing philosophy; synchronized blockade lift; IHTA architecture |
| RCSA Simplified Edition 2026        | Modular track system; sovereignty preservation; economic ladder               |
| RCSA v3.6 Final Diplomatic Edition  | Verification architecture; risk appetite framework; guarantor model           |
| Modular Hormuz Solutions Annex v1.0 | 100 pathways for Hormuz governance, security, and economics                   |
| Modular Nuclear Solutions Annex 1.0 | 100 pathways for stockpile disposition and facility conversion                |

## **What This Document Is Not**

This is not a comprehensive peace treaty. It does not resolve the ballistic missile question, Lebanon final status, Yemen reconstruction, Iraqi militia integration, or the Israeli-Palestinian question. Those matters are reserved for successor frameworks. This Accord creates the stable platform upon which those harder questions can be addressed.

## **How to Read This Document**

Negotiators should read Section 1 (Principles), Section 2 (Overview), and Section 9 (What Each Side Wins) first. Technical specialists should then focus on their domain: Hormuz (Sections 3, 6), Nuclear (Sections 4, 7), Verification (Section 8), or Crisis Management (Section 11). The Appendices provide quick-reference tools for use during active negotiation.

## Section 1: Eight Core Principles

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Every provision in this Accord is governed by eight foundational principles. These are not aspirational language -- they are the structural rules that ensure the agreement survives implementation.

### **Principle 1: Synchronized Reciprocal Motion**

Neither side moves alone. Every Iranian commitment is matched by a corresponding US commitment on the same day or the next sequential day. Every US commitment is matched by a corresponding Iranian commitment. Verification is shared. This is not mere political optics -- it is structural. Both governments can credibly claim the other moved first or simultaneously.

### **Principle 2: Modular Architecture**

The Accord operates through independent modules. Failure in one module does not collapse the others. If nuclear verification encounters a dispute, Hormuz transit continues. If sanctions relief faces a delay, the ceasefire holds. This prevents the total-collapse failure mode that destroyed the JCPOA.

### **Principle 3: Sovereignty Preservation**

This framework does not supersede any constitution. It does not create supranational authority. It does not impair sovereign defense rights. It does not force alliance realignment. Iran's NPT rights are preserved. US treaty commitments to Gulf partners are preserved. Both governments retain full constitutional authority.

### **Principle 4: Irreversible Facts on the Ground**

Each stage produces physically irreversible deliverables. Once Iran's weapons-grade stockpile is transferred to IAEA custody in Oman, it cannot be silently returned. Once \$250 million in Iranian



assets is transferred, it cannot be clawed back. Once Hormuz is reopened and the IHTA is operating, closure requires a deliberate political decision with visible consequences. These irreversible facts create constituencies for continuation.

#### **Principle 5: Multiple Pathways for Every Major Issue**

Rather than demanding a single solution, the Accord provides modular options for Hormuz governance, nuclear disposition, and verification intensity. Parties select the combination that fits their political constraints. The appendices contain selection guides for rapid decision-making.

#### **Principle 6: Quiet Compliance**

Minor violations are corrected confidentially through the Joint Implementation Group, not through public accusations. The framework distinguishes between technical discrepancies (corrected quietly) and material breaches (addressed formally). This protects domestic political space for both governments.

#### **Principle 7: Neither Recognition Nor Surrender**

Participation in this Accord does not constitute diplomatic recognition where none exists. It does not require either government to acknowledge defeat, capitulation, or unconditional surrender. Each government may characterize the outcome in terms that serve its domestic political requirements, provided objective benchmarks are met.

#### **Principle 8: Succession Resilience**

The Accord binds institutions, not individuals. Commitments attach to the Office of the President, the Department of State, the Supreme National Security Council, the Central Bank, and the Majlis. Changes of government activate continuity provisions rather than withdrawal procedures.

## Section 2: Framework Overview

### 2.1 The Three Stages at a Glance

The Accord operates as three sequenced stages, each with defined entry conditions, obligations, verification standards, and transition triggers. The architecture is deliberately modular: failure at any stage does not collapse prior stages.

Table 2: The Three-Stage Framework -- Deferred Sequencing Model

| Stage                                    | Duration             | Primary Goal                                                                                                                                              | Closing Trigger                                                                                    |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Stage 1: The Opening</b> (14-Day MoU) | Days 1-14            | End the war; transfer stockpile to IAEA custody; reopen Hormuz; lift both blockades; <i>nuclear specifics deferred</i>                                    | Both blockades lifted; 200+ vessel transits; IAEA custody verified; 14-point MoU fully operational |
| <b>Stage 2: The Deferred Window</b>      | Days 15-44 (30 days) | Negotiate nuclear moratorium specifics (12-15 years); HEU export logistics; underground facility protocols; snap inspections; sanctions relief sequencing | Nuclear moratorium ratified; HEU export plan confirmed; 50% assets returned; SWIFT process begun   |
| <b>Stage 3: Permanent Architecture</b>   | Days 45-180          | IHTA treaty; regional security dialogue; full normalization; Fordow conversion completion                                                                 | IHTA charter ratified; 85% assets returned; successor framework opened                             |

#### Key Structural Innovation: The 30-Day Deferred Window

Unlike the original Stability First Accord, which front-loaded nuclear commitments into Stage 1, the Enhanced Accord adopts the breakthrough sequencing confirmed by May 7-8, 2026 negotiations:

- **Stage 1** focuses exclusively on ending the war, reopening Hormuz, and creating the conditions for trust
- **Stage 2** -- the 30-day window opened by the 14-point MoU -- contains the full nuclear architecture
- This decoupling prevents nuclear disputes from blocking the immediate humanitarian and economic imperatives

## 2.2 Synchronized Reciprocal Motion

The sequencing follows the Waltz Philosophy of synchronized reciprocal motion. The principle is simple: each commitment by one party is matched by a corresponding commitment by the other; neither party is exposed to defection; verification is shared.

### Example: Day 1 Synchronization (14-Day MoU)

**Table 3: Day 1 Deliverables -- 14-Point MoU Immediate Actions**

| Party                | Action                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Verification                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Iran</b>          | Initiate transfer of 60%-enriched uranium stockpile to IAEA custody in Oman; cease all offensive operations; transmit Hezbollah operational pause instruction; transmit Houthi Red Sea pause instruction; commit to moratorium framework (duration deferred to 30-day window) | IAEA Director-General confirmation; mass spectrometry; continuous CCTV and satellite monitoring; Pakistani PM Office + UN Special Envoy concurrent certification |
| <b>United States</b> | Suspend Project Freedom; cease all offensive operations; issue OFAC license for \$250M pilot asset release; commit to 30-day nuclear negotiation window                                                                                                                       | CENTCOM operational order; Pakistani guarantor confirmation; Iranian Central Bank confirms receipt                                                               |

## 2.3 Modular Design

Six independent tracks advance at their own pace. Progress in one does not depend on progress in another:

**Table 4: Six Independent Implementation Tracks**

| Track              | Introduced                            | Governing Body                            | Independent Advancement              |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Nuclear            | Day 1 (framework); Day 15 (specifics) | IAEA + Joint Implementation Group         | Yes -- based on IAEA metrics         |
| Maritime Security  | Day 1                                 | IHTA Council + Maritime Coordination Cell | Yes -- based on transit data         |
| Economic/Sanctions | Day 7                                 | JIG + Swiss Channel + OFAC                | Yes -- based on financial compliance |
| Humanitarian       | Day 1                                 | UN OCHA + IHTA                            | Yes -- cannot be paused              |
| Regional Security  | Day 75                                | JIG + expanded membership                 | Requires core party consent          |

**The Rule of Independent Tracks**

While tracks advance independently, certain combinations unlock additional benefits:

- Nuclear Track stabilizes + Economic Track activates = SWIFT reconnection pathway opens
- Security Track and Humanitarian Track both advance = Regional Development Fund Stage 2 releases
- Any track may be paused for recalibration without affecting other tracks
- Humanitarian Track operates at full capacity at all times and cannot be paused

**2.4 The Transition to Deferred Sequencing**

The Enhanced Accord reflects the real-world diplomatic trajectory that transformed the negotiations between May 3-8, 2026:

**Table 5: Evolution from Nuclear-First to Nuclear-Deferred**

| Element                    | April 2026 (Nuclear-First)          | May 7-8, 2026 (Deferred Model)                         |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Precondition for ceasefire | Full HEU export; zero enrichment    | Commitment to moratorium framework; specifics deferred |
| Hormuz reopening           | Contingent on nuclear dismantlement | Immediate; synchronized with blockade lift             |
| Asset release              | Contingent on nuclear compliance    | \$250M pilot on Day 1; tranches during 30-day window   |
| Moratorium duration        | US demanded 20 years                | 12-15 years (actively negotiated in 30-day window)     |
| Underground facilities     | Immediate dismantlement             | Protocols negotiated in 30-day window                  |
| Inspections                | Unlimited snap inspections          | Enhanced regime; specifics in 30-day window            |

## Section 3: Stage One -- The 14-Day Opening (Days 1-14)

Stage One is the implementation of the 14-point MoU. It runs for 14 days from signature and produces seven irreversible operational deliverables. By Day 14, the dual blockade is lifted, the Joint Hormuz Authority is operating in provisional mode, the war-fighting domain is closed, the first sovereign asset transfer is complete, and Iran's weapons-grade enriched uranium stockpile is under verified IAEA custody in a third country. **Crucially, the nuclear specifics -- moratorium duration, HEU export logistics, underground facility protocols -- are committed to but deferred to the 30-day window.**

### 3.1 Day 1: Ceasefire and War Termination

At 0000 GMT on Day 1, a permanent bilateral ceasefire takes effect on all US-Iran fronts. The following occur simultaneously:

#### Nuclear Framework Commitment (Day 1) -- NOT Full Resolution

On Day 1, Iran makes a binding *framework commitment* to:

- A moratorium on uranium enrichment above 3.67% (specific duration to be negotiated within the 30-day window; landing zone 12-15 years)
- Export of the HEU stockpile (logistics and destination to be finalized in the 30-day window)
- Enhanced inspections regime (scope to be defined in the 30-day window)
- Protocols for underground facilities (Natanz/Fordow -- conversion plan to be negotiated in the 30-day window)

This is the critical innovation of deferred sequencing: Iran makes binding commitments to the *framework* on Day 1, but the detailed implementation is negotiated over the subsequent 30 days. This satisfies the US requirement for immediate nuclear progress while giving Iran the political space to negotiate specifics after the war has ended and economic relief has begun.

Table 6: Day 1 Deliverables -- 14-Point MoU

| Party | Action | Verification |
|-------|--------|--------------|
|-------|--------|--------------|

|                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Iran</b>          | Initiate transfer of 60%-enriched uranium stockpile to IAEA custody in Oman; cease all offensive operations; transmit Hezbollah operational pause; transmit Houthi Red Sea pause; <b>commit to nuclear moratorium framework (specifics deferred to 30-day window)</b> | IAEA Director-General confirmation; mass spectrometry; continuous CCTV; Pakistani PM Office + UN Special Envoy + Omani channel + Swiss financial channel concurrent certification |
| <b>United States</b> | Suspend Project Freedom; cease all offensive operations; issue OFAC general license for \$250M pilot asset transfer; confirm Sovereign Energy Partnership framing; <b>open 30-day nuclear negotiation window</b>                                                      | CENTCOM operational order; Pakistani guarantor confirmation; Iranian Central Bank confirms receipt                                                                                |

**Why the \$250 Million Pilot Matters:** The pilot asset transfer is unconditional and non-reversible. It is not a payment or reparations -- it is the return of Iranian sovereign property. It creates an immediate, visible Iranian win that generates domestic political space for the nuclear steps that follow. The pilot also creates a US interest in completion: once \$250 million has been transferred, the political cost of reversal for the US rises.

### 3.2 Day 3: Humanitarian Corridor Opens

On Day 3, the first humanitarian-flagged vessel transits the Strait of Hormuz under Joint Hormuz Authority observation. This is a zero-fee, no-inspection-delay transit for food, medicine, medical equipment, and UN supplies. The humanitarian corridor operates at all maturity levels and cannot be paused regardless of disputes in other tracks.

### 3.3 Day 7: Synchronized Dual Blockade Lift

The single most important mechanical element of Stage One is the synchronized lifting of the dual blockade on Day 7.

**Step 1 (Day 1):** Both governments issue identical written declarations to the Pakistani guarantor, Omani technical channel, and Swiss financial channel, committing to the synchronized lift on Day 7.

**Step 2 (Days 1-6):** The Joint Hormuz Authority's Maritime Coordination Cell in Muscat finalizes Day 7 operational protocols. Iran's transit-permit system transitions to JHA-coordinated electronic clearance. US Fifth Fleet establishes coordination links with Iranian Navy through the Omani-hosted hotline.

**Step 3 (Day 7, 0000 GMT):** Both lifts declared operative simultaneously. JHA observation vessels (US, Iranian, Omani flagged, with international observers) take station at Khasab and Bandar Abbas.

**Step 4 (Day 7 +24h):** First commercial vessel transits in each direction under JHA observation. Lloyd's List and UN OCHA confirm. JHA issues first daily transit report.

**Step 5 (Day 7 +72h):** If either lift is not verified by this point, the unlifted side's lift commitment is suspended. Matter referred to JHA emergency session and Pakistani guarantor. Default: maintain both blockades until synchronization is achieved.

### 3.4 Day 14: Stage One Closing

By Day 14, the following must be verified for Stage One to close:

- Both blockades lifted and verified (JHA observation vessels; Lloyd's List; UN OCHA; guarantor naval observers)
- At least 200 cumulative commercial vessel transits in the 14-day period
- IAEA confirms weapons-grade stockpile in secure custody in Oman
- Ceasefire intact with no verified offensive operations by either side
- JHA provisional mode confirmed with operational Maritime Coordination Cell
- First humanitarian corridor transits confirmed
- **Binding framework commitment to nuclear moratorium, HEU export, and enhanced inspections registered with JIG** (specifics to be negotiated in 30-day window)

Upon verification by Pakistan, Oman, and Switzerland concurrently, Stage One closes automatically and the 30-day deferred window (Stage 2) begins.

### US Commitments in Stage One

- Cease all offensive military operations against Iran, Iranian forces, and Iranian-linked installations
- Lift the naval blockade on Iranian commercial ports on Day 7 in synchronized motion
- Suspend Project Freedom unilateral escort operations on Day 1
- Issue OFAC general license for \$250M pilot asset transfer on Day 1
- Issue OFAC general license for humanitarian trade within 14 days (medicine, medical equipment, food, agricultural inputs)
- Pause all new sanctions designations for Stage One duration
- **Open 30-day nuclear negotiation window with good-faith commitment to reach moratorium specifics**

- Confirm in writing that the nuclear exchange is a Sovereign Energy Partnership, not an imposed dismantlement

### **Iranian Commitments in Stage One**

- Cease all offensive operations against US forces, US bases, and US-flagged or US-affiliated vessels
- Open the Strait of Hormuz beginning Day 3 (humanitarian) and Day 7 (full commercial), synchronized with US blockade lift
- Withdraw IRGC small craft from positions within 5 nautical miles of the central transit corridor
- Commence good-faith mine-clearing operations with JHA Maritime Safety Working Group
- Initiate stockpile transfer to IAEA custody on Day 1; maintain no enrichment above 3.67% from Day 1 forward
- **Commit to nuclear moratorium framework (12-15 year landing zone; specifics negotiated in 30-day window)**
- **Commit to HEU export (logistics finalized in 30-day window)**
- Transmit to Houthi leadership an instruction to implement a Red Sea operational pause on commercial shipping



## Section 4: The 30-Day Deferred Window (Days 15-44)

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Stage Two is the heart of the Enhanced Accord's innovation. It converts the operational stabilization of Stage One into durable economic, institutional, and nuclear measures. This is the 30-day window opened by the 14-point MoU, confirmed by reporting from *Axios*, *The Wall Street Journal*, and multiple diplomatic sources on May 7-8, 2026.

By Day 44, the nuclear moratorium is ratified with specific duration and terms, the HEU export logistics are confirmed, underground facility protocols are agreed, half of Iran's frozen sovereign assets have been returned, the first sanctions tranche is operative, the IAEA has fully redeployed, and the comprehensive nuclear exchange framework is verified complete.

### The 30-Day Window: What Gets Negotiated

According to confirmed reporting (May 7-8, 2026), the following issues are explicitly deferred to this 30-day window:

- **Enrichment moratorium duration:** 12-15 years (compromise between Iran's 5-year offer and US 20-year demand)
- **HEU stockpile disposition:** Export logistics, destination country, timeline
- **Underground facility protocols:** Natanz and Fordow operating parameters, conversion timelines
- **Inspection regime:** Snap inspections scope, IAEA Additional Protocol, verification intensity
- **Sanctions relief sequencing:** Gradual lifting architecture, sectoral prioritization
- **Asset return tranches:** Amounts, timing, triggers

### 4.1 Nuclear Moratorium Architecture

The current MoU discussions include a moratorium on uranium enrichment of between 12 and 15 years, with Iran's 5-year offer and the US 20-year demand converging toward this range. This Accord adopts a 12-year moratorium with a violation-extension mechanism, as confirmed by *Axios* reporting (May 6, 2026):

**Table 7: Enrichment Moratorium Structure -- 30-Day Window Negotiation**

| Phase                 | Duration                         | Enrichment Standard                                                             | Condition for Advancement                                                  |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Moratorium Phase      | Years 1-12 (minimum; extendable) | Zero enrichment above 3.67%. All higher-enrichment centrifuges under IAEA seal. | Clean IAEA certification at 12-year review; no material breach             |
| Civilian Transition   | Years 13-15                      | 3.67% enrichment for civilian fuel-cycle purposes at Natanz only                | Fuel supply guarantee deposited in escrow; Section 123 Agreement operative |
| Steady-State Civilian | Year 16 onwards                  | 3.67% enrichment under full IAEA safeguards; RCSA Phase 3 architecture          | RCSA five-year renewal confirmed; all compliance indicators at green       |

**Automatic Extension Mechanism:** Any material breach of enrichment limits triggers automatic moratorium extension of 2 years per breach. Extension is determined by Joint Implementation Group majority on the basis of IAEA technical reporting, not by unilateral US certification. This prevents the extension mechanism from becoming a tool for geopolitical pressure unrelated to actual nuclear behavior.

**Why 12-15 Years:** As *Axios* reported (May 6, 2026), three sources confirmed the 12-year figure as the likely landing zone, with one source suggesting 15 years. The Enhanced Accord selects 12 as the base moratorium with optional extension to 15 through the violation-extension mechanism -- giving Iran a path to the shorter duration through clean compliance while providing the US with the longer duration if violations occur.

## 4.2 HEU Stockpile Export Logistics

The disposition of Iran's transferred weapons-grade material is negotiated during the 30-day window. The stockpile was transferred to IAEA custody in Oman during Stage 1; the 30-day window finalizes the export logistics:

**Table 8: HEU Export Logistics -- 30-Day Window Negotiation**

| Element             | Day 1 Status       | 30-Day Window Outcome                                 |
|---------------------|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Stockpile location  | IAEA custody, Oman | Confirmed; export destination selected                |
| Export destination  | Deferred           | Oman (default), Russia, Kazakhstan, or US             |
| Transport method    | Deferred           | IAEA-secured convoy; route confirmed                  |
| Timeline for export | Deferred           | Finalized; typically 14-30 days from Day 44           |
| Final disposition   | Deferred           | Down-blending, fuel fabrication, or long-term custody |

**Default Option (N-1): IAEA Third-Country Custody (Oman Model)**

Material remains in IAEA-controlled storage at the Oman custody facility. The facility is under IAEA control -- not US control. Disposition follows IAEA procedures with Iranian consent for any final disposition decision. US framing: "Weapons-grade material removed from Iranian territory under international control." Iranian framing: "Sovereign asset held in trust under IAEA supervision, not surrendered to any single power. Iran chose Oman as the neutral custody location."

**4.3 Underground Facility Protocols**

The status of Iran's underground enrichment facilities -- Fordow and Natanz -- is negotiated during the 30-day window, as confirmed by *The Wall Street Journal* (May 7, 2026):

**Table 9: Underground Facility Protocols -- 30-Day Window Negotiation**

| Facility | US Position               | Iranian Position                   | Likely Landing Zone                                                        |
|----------|---------------------------|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fordow   | Dismantlement             | Preserve for research              | Convert to medical-isotope research center (IMIRC); enrichment ceases      |
| Natanz   | No underground enrichment | NPT rights to civilian enrichment  | Open-fuel-cycle research campus; 3.67% civilian enrichment post-moratorium |
| Isfahan  | Dismantlement             | Preserve nuclear technology center | IAEA regional training hub for safeguards inspectors                       |

**Fordow Conversion Timeline:** By Day 60, Fordow conversion begins to a medical-isotope research center producing molybdenum-99, iodine-131, and xenon-133 for regional healthcare under international consortium management. The conversion proceeds through four stages: Phase A (cessation of enrichment; IAEA seals), Phase B (removal of UF6; down-blending), Phase C (removal of enrichment infrastructure; IAEA-monitored storage), Phase D (IMIRC activation -- medical isotope production under co-management).

**4.4 Inspections and Verification**

The enhanced inspections regime is defined during the 30-day window:

- **Snap inspections:** IAEA unannounced access to declared sites (scope and frequency defined in 30-day window)
- **Continuous monitoring:** Real-time data transmission from Natanz, Isfahan, and Oman custody facility
- **Environmental sampling:** Weekly at declared sites; monthly at the Oman custody facility

- **IAEA Director-General reporting:** Weekly technical reports to JIG and UN Security Council
- **Underground facility access:** Protocols for Fordow and Natanz inspection defined in 30-day window

## 4.5 Sanctions Relief and Asset Return

Approximately \$100-120 billion in Iranian sovereign assets remains frozen across multiple jurisdictions. The 30-day window finalizes the tranche structure:

**Table 10: Asset Return Tranche Architecture -- 30-Day Window Finalization**

| Tranche                 | Timing    | Amount          | Trigger                                                                        | Reversibility                              |
|-------------------------|-----------|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Pilot (Stage 1)         | Day 1     | \$250M          | Signature                                                                      | Non-reversible                             |
| Tranche (Stage 2)       | 1 Day 30  | 25% minus pilot | Stage 1 closed; IAEA custody verified; moratorium framework committed          | Non-reversible                             |
| Tranche (Stage 2 close) | 2 Day 44  | 25%             | 30-day compliance; nuclear moratorium ratified; HEU export plan confirmed      | Non-reversible                             |
| Tranche (Stage 3)       | 3 Day 120 | 20%             | Permanent IHTA operational; 30-day remediation window; Stage 3 dialogue opened | 30-day remediation                         |
| Tranche (Stage 3 close) | 4 Day 180 | 15%             | 180-day compliance; nuclear exchange maintained                                | Subject to JIG material-breach review      |
| Reserve                 | Day 365   | 10%             | 12 months sustained compliance                                                 | Held pending material-breach determination |
| Balance (RCSA)          | Year 2-3  | Remainder       | Full RCSA Phase 2-3 compliance                                                 | RCSA risk appetite framework               |

## 4.6 Day 44: Deferred Window Closing

By Day 44, the following must be verified for Stage Two to close:

- Nuclear moratorium ratified with specific duration (12-15 years) and terms
- HEU export plan confirmed with timeline and destination
- Underground facility protocols agreed (Fordow conversion plan; Natanz parameters)
- Enhanced inspections regime defined and IAEA fully redeployed
- 50% of frozen assets returned (cumulative; non-reversible)

- SWIFT reconnection process begun
- Sanctions relief tranches defined and first tranche operative
- No material breach of moratorium framework during 30-day window

Upon verification by Pakistan, Oman, Switzerland, and IAEA Director-General concurrently, Stage Two closes automatically and Stage Three begins.

# Section 5: Stage Three -- Permanent Architecture (Days 45-180)

Stage Three converts the provisional arrangements into permanent architecture and opens the broader regional dialogue. It is the bridge to the comprehensive successor framework.

## 5.1 The International Hormuz Transit Authority

On Day 90, the provisional Joint Hormuz Authority converts to the permanent International Hormuz Transit Authority (IHTA) by treaty.

Table 11: IHTA Council Composition

| Member                         | Status                              | Role                                                           |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Islamic Republic of Iran       | Permanent voting member             | Senior permanent seat; chair authority in alternating years    |
| United States                  | Permanent voting member             | Permanent seat; co-chair authority in alternating years        |
| GCC Rotating Chair             | Permanent voting member             | Annual rotation among Oman, Qatar, UAE; tie-breaking authority |
| European Union                 | Observer (speaking rights, no vote) | Chairs Environmental and Safety Subcommittee                   |
| People's Republic of China     | Observer (speaking rights, no vote) | Technical observer; largest Gulf-oil importer                  |
| UN Secretary-General Appointee | Neutral chair                       | Non-voting; tie-breaking on procedural matters                 |

## 5.2 Regional Security Dialogue

Stage Three does not produce a comprehensive missile agreement. It produces a Regional Security Dialogue framework establishing parameters for confidence-building measures: ballistic-missile range notification protocols, regional non-proliferation architecture, proxy operational monitoring mechanisms, and verification architecture including satellite monitoring and JIG-facilitated incident review.

### 5.3 Full Normalization Path

By Day 180, the successor framework -- RCSA v3.6, Crescent Compact v1.7, or RAMES v9.1 -- is formally opened for negotiation. The Stability First Enhanced Accord has created the stable platform upon which these comprehensive frameworks can be built.

#### **Day 180 deliverables:**

- Permanent IHTA charter ratified and in force
- 85% of frozen assets returned (cumulative)
- Successor framework negotiations opened
- Section 123 Agreement (civilian fuel supply guarantee) negotiation framework established
- Regional Security Dialogue active with agenda agreed
- Fordow conversion to IMIRC underway (Phase D activation)

## Section 6: Modular Hormuz Solutions

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The negotiation over Hormuz governance often becomes stuck on a single question: "Who controls the Strait?" This binary framing produces deadlock. The Modular Hormuz Solutions framework dismantles this binary by providing multiple governance, security, and economic options.

### Governance Pathways

**G-1: Joint Hormuz Authority (JHA) Provisional Council** -- Speed: 7 days. Establish the provisional JHA with US and Iran as permanent voting members, rotating GCC chair, and EU/China/India as observers. Council meets in Muscat. US framing: "US co-governance replaces unilateral enforcement burden." Iranian framing: "Iran recognized as permanent co-equal sovereign authority over Hormuz."

**G-2: Tripartite Council with GCC Rotating Tie-Breaker** -- Simplified three-member body: US, Iran, and rotating GCC representative. The GCC member holds tie-breaking authority. US framing: "Streamlined decision-making with regional Arab stakeholder as neutral arbiter." Iranian framing: "No permanent US majority; Muslim Gulf state ensures fair arbitration."

**G-3: Dual-Track Governance** -- Separate political decision-making from technical operations. Political disputes do not disrupt technical operations.

**G-4: IMO-Mandated Observer Mission** -- UN International Maritime Organization observer mission without operational command authority.

### Security Pathways

**S-1: Synchronized Day-7 Dual Blockade Lift Protocol (Required)**

**S-2: Omani-Hosted 24/7 De-Confliction Hotline Network (Required)**

**S-3: Unmanned Picket Line (Autonomous Sensor Network)**

**S-4: Naval Encounter Code of Conduct (INCSEA-Adapted)**

**S-5: IRGC-Navy Force Posture Adjustment Protocol**

**S-6: Regional Coast Guard Partnership**

### Economic Pathways

**E-1: \$20 Billion US DFC-Chubb Reinsurance Backstop**

**E-2: Tiered Commercial Transit Toll System (~\$500M annually)**



**E-3:** Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund (40% of toll revenues)

**E-4:** Humanitarian Zero-Toll Fast Track (insulated from all snapbacks)

**Recommended Default Portfolio**

**Table 12: Recommended Default Hormuz Portfolio**

| Category   | Selection                                  | Rationale                                      |
|------------|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Governance | G-1 (JHA Provisional) transitioning to G-2 | Fast start with lean permanent structure       |
| Security   | S-1 + S-2 + S-3 + S-5                      | Core safety plus de-escalation technology      |
| Economic   | E-1 + E-2 + E-3 + E-4                      | Immediate stabilization plus long-term revenue |

# Section 7: Modular Nuclear Solutions

The nuclear architecture is the framework's most sensitive component. The Enhanced Accord's innovation is that these options are negotiated during the 30-day deferred window rather than imposed as preconditions.

## Current Negotiation Parameters (May 2026)

Table 13: Nuclear Negotiation Landing Zones -- 30-Day Window

| Issue                  | US Position    | Iran Position       | Likely Landing Zone                        |
|------------------------|----------------|---------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Enrichment moratorium  | 20 years       | 5 years             | 12-15 years (actively negotiated)          |
| HEU disposition        | Transfer to US | Remain in Iran      | Third-country IAEA custody (Oman)          |
| Underground facilities | Prohibited     | NPT rights asserted | IAEA-monitored conversion                  |
| Fordow                 | Dismantlement  | Preserve            | Convert to medical-isotope research center |
| Snap inspections       | Required       | Rejected            | Enhanced declared-site + IAEA unannounced  |

## Stockpile Disposition Options (Deferred Window)

**N-1: IAEA Third-Country Custody (Oman Model)** -- RECOMMENDED DEFAULT. Speed: 14 days. Material in IAEA-controlled storage. Neither US nor Iran controls.

**N-2: Fuel Assembly Conversion** -- Speed: 90 days. Weapons-grade material diluted and fabricated into fuel assemblies for Bushehr. Maximizes Iranian economic value.

**N-3: Russian Federation Custodial Partnership** -- Speed: 60-90 days. Transfer to Rosatom-operated storage under IAEA safeguards.

**N-4: Kazakhstan LEU Bank Custody** -- Speed: 75-105 days. Transfer to IAEA LEU Bank in Oskemen.

## Facility Transformation Options (Deferred Window)

**F-1: Fordow International Medical Isotope Research Center (IMIRC)** -- RECOMMENDED DEFAULT. Timeline: 18-36 months.

**F-2: Natanz Open-Fuel-Cycle Research Campus** -- Timeline: 24-36 months.

**F-3: Isfahan Nuclear Technology Exhibition and Training Center** -- Timeline: 24 months.

## Recommended Default Nuclear Portfolio

**Table 14: Recommended Default Nuclear Portfolio -- 30-Day Selection**

| Category     | Selection                                                                 | Rationale                                                    |
|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Stockpile    | N-1 (Oman IAEA Custody)                                                   | Fastest; neutral; neither US nor Iran controls               |
| Facilities   | F-1 (Fordow IMIRC) + F-2 (Natanz Campus) + F-3 (Isfahan Training)         | Complete transformation of all three facilities              |
| Verification | V-1 (Continuous Monitoring) + V-2 (Discrepancy Panel) + V-3 (Wins Ledger) | Robust verification with dispute resolution and transparency |

# Section 8: Five-Channel Verification

Verification is the spine of the Accord. The architecture follows the principle that no single verification channel can either trigger or block compliance determinations on its own. Every material finding requires convergent evidence from at least two independent channels.

Table 15: The Five Verification Channels

| Channel                  | Active                              | Coverage                                                                                                                                     | Reporting Authority                                                                          |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Pakistani Mediator       | Throughout                          | Bilateral diplomatic channel; ceasefire compliance; major commitment certification; crisis hotline                                           | Pakistani Prime Minister's Office and designated envoy                                       |
| Omani Technical          | Throughout                          | Maritime operations; JHA observation; hotline; mine clearance; nuclear custody facility oversight                                            | Omani Foreign Ministry and JHA Secretariat Director                                          |
| Swiss Financial          | Throughout                          | Asset transfer verification; sanctions relief implementation; escrow management; banking reconnection                                        | Swiss Federal Department of Foreign Affairs                                                  |
| IAEA                     | From Day 1 (custody); Day 15 (full) | Nuclear exchange verification: stockpile custody, enrichment moratorium, Fordow conversion; environmental sampling; weekly technical reports | IAEA Director General; reports to JIG and UN Security Council                                |
| National Technical Means | Throughout                          | Satellite imagery, signals intelligence, all national capabilities. Used as backstop and discrepancy detector                                | US, partner intelligence services; discrepancies referred to JIG Technical Discrepancy Panel |

## Risk Appetite Framework

Table 16: Risk Appetite Framework

| Tier | Level          | Example Triggers                                                                           | Response                               |
|------|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| 1    | Zero Tolerance | Nuclear weapons-related activity; diversion of fissile material; attack on IAEA inspectors | Immediate snapback; highest escalation |

|   |                       |                                                                                        |                                                                                  |
|---|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2 | Minimal Tolerance     | Enrichment above agreed limits by >20%; obstruction of IAEA access >72 hours           | Snapback presumed but rebuttable; 30-day Panel review                            |
| 3 | Managed Tolerance     | Technical reporting delays; minor centrifuge discrepancies; disbursement timing issues | Graduated response; technical assistance, extended timeline, guarantor mediation |
| 4 | Strategic Flexibility | Political disagreements; domestic legislative delays; protocol disputes                | Snapback prohibited; diplomatic and guarantor-led resolution required            |
| 5 | Absorbed Risk         | Force majeure; natural disasters affecting compliance; neutral guarantor incapacity    | No penalties; automatic Trigger Dampening Window activated                       |

### Joint Implementation Group

The JIG is the central coordination body for Stages 2 and 3, hosted in Geneva. Membership: United States, Iran, Pakistan, Oman, Switzerland, EU observer, UN Special Envoy. PRC and GCC rotating chair join as observers in Stage 3. The JIG meets in plenary every 30 days, with technical working groups in continuous session. Material-breach determinations require majority of permanent members (US, Iran, Pakistan, Oman, Switzerland), with Pakistan as facilitating chair.

## Section 9: What Each Side Wins

This section provides the diplomatic framing that enables each government to defend the Accord to its domestic audience. Every claim below is factually supportable from the text of the Accord.

### What the United States Wins

**Table 17: US Deliverables and Timeline**

| Win                                   | Specific Deliverable                                                                                          | Day Verified                        |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Strait of Hormuz reopened             | 200+ commercial vessel transits per 14-day period; gas-pump prices begin falling within weeks                 | Day 14                              |
| Project Freedom succeeded             | Escort assets transition to JHA convoy support; President can credibly claim operation achieved its objective | Day 7                               |
| Freedom of navigation guaranteed      | IHTA Charter formally guarantees transit in international law; Iran cannot unilaterally close                 | Day 90 (permanent)                  |
| Weapons-grade stockpile secured       | Entire 60%-enriched stockpile in IAEA third-country custody, verified by mass spectrometry                    | Day 1 initiated; Day 14 verified    |
| 12-year enrichment moratorium secured | Moratorium on enrichment above 3.67% with IAEA continuous monitoring; violation automatically extends         | Day 44 (30-day window ratification) |
| Fordow converted                      | Fortified Fordow facility producing medical isotopes, not enriching uranium                                   | Day 60 (conversion begins)          |
| No basing concessions                 | All US Gulf bases remain; all treaty obligations to GCC partners preserved; no troop withdrawals              | Day 1 (confirmed in text)           |
| Congressional oversight preserved     | Each asset tranche from Tranche 3 forward subject to 30-day Congressional review window                       | Throughout                          |
| Israeli security backstop             | Weapons-grade stockpile secured; moratorium in force; Lebanon track separated                                 | Day 1 onward                        |

**Recommended US Domestic Messaging:** "We secured the opening of Hormuz, the elimination of Iran's weapons-grade uranium from its territory, a 12-year moratorium on enrichment, and the conversion of Fordow to peaceful use. We got Iranian assets returned in tranches with Congressional review at every step. We didn't give up a single base. American forces remain in the region. And we did it without losing another

American life. The nuclear details were negotiated over 30 days, not imposed in a day -- that's how you get a deal that actually sticks."

## What Iran Wins

**Table 18: Iranian Deliverables and Timeline**

| Win                                 | Specific Deliverable                                                                                                     | Day Verified                        |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| War ends permanently                | Permanent bilateral ceasefire; UN-registered; war-fighting domain closed within 14 days                                  | Day 1 (ceasefire); Day 14 (closing) |
| US naval blockade lifted            | Synchronized with Hormuz reopening on Day 7; Iranian commercial ports restored                                           | Day 7                               |
| Permanent IHTA governance seat      | Permanent voting seat with chair authority on alternating years; formal Iranian co-equality replacing US unilateralism   | Day 90 (permanent IHTA)             |
| \$200M/year reconstruction revenue  | 40% of IHTA revenues to Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund; World Bank trustee oversight; Iranian programmatic control | Day 45 (tolling begins)             |
| Return of sovereign assets          | \$250M Day 1; cumulative 50% by Day 44 (non-reversible); cumulative 85% by Day 180                                       | Staged through Day 180              |
| Comprehensive sanctions relief      | Humanitarian Day 1; aviation/consumer Day 30; SWIFT Day 60; petrochemicals Day 120; full normalization Year 3+           | Staged                              |
| NPT rights preserved                | Enrichment continues at 3.67% after moratorium under guaranteed fuel supply; civilian nuclear rights fully preserved     | Throughout                          |
| Missile program untouched           | Ballistic missile file entirely deferred to Stage 3 Regional Security Dialogue                                           | Day 1 (confirmed in text)           |
| Constitutional governance preserved | No requirement on Iranian internal governance; Supreme Leader succession unaffected                                      | Day 1 (confirmed in text)           |

**Recommended Iranian Domestic Messaging:** "We have ended the war. The American naval blockade of our ports has been lifted. Our frozen sovereign property is returning. The Strait of Hormuz is governed by an international authority on which Iran holds a permanent seat -- replacing decades of American unilateralism. We have chosen to redirect our nuclear program toward guaranteed civilian energy leadership. Our NPT rights remain inviolable; our sovereignty is intact. The moratorium is a sovereign choice, not an imposed surrender -- and we negotiated every detail over 30 days, not in a moment of weakness."

## What the Region Wins

**Table 19: Regional Benefits**

| Stakeholder                |  | Key Benefit                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------|--|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Saudi Arabia & Gulf States |  | Predictable energy transit; reduced nuclear threat perception; GCC rotating chair on IHTA Council; no new concessions required                |
| Israel                     |  | Weapons-grade stockpile secured; 12-year moratorium removes reconstitution timeline; Hezbollah operational pause; quiet acquiescence expected |
| Pakistan                   |  | Confirmed primary mediator role; institutionalized guarantor status; strengthened bilateral relationships                                     |
| Oman                       |  | IHTA secretariat in Muscat; Maritime Coordination Cell in Khasab; IAEA custody facility; permanent institutional centrality                   |
| France/EU                  |  | 40-nation coalition finds legitimate institutional home; EU chairs Environmental and Safety Subcommittee                                      |
| China & India              |  | Predictable energy supply; IHTA technical observer status; documented role in stabilization                                                   |
| Global Energy Markets      |  | 20% of global oil and gas returns to predictable transit; Brent crude stabilization                                                           |



## Section 10: Safeguards and Protections

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**Key Safeguard 1: Failure Without War.** Framework failure does not restore war conditions. If the Accord collapses, the bilateral ceasefire remains in force unless explicitly renounced by either party. The 150-day inertia buffer means no instant sanctions snapback.

**Key Safeguard 2: Stabilization Holds.** When a specific Accord measure becomes domestically untenable in either capital, that measure can be placed on Stabilization Hold for up to 90 days. During the Hold: all other obligations remain in force. Maximum two Stabilization Holds per stage. Nuclear exchange steps are not eligible for Hold.

**Key Safeguard 3: Emergency Ambiguity Authority.** The neutral chair possesses Emergency Ambiguity Authority -- the capacity to introduce controlled procedural ambiguity that prevents immediate escalation when clarification would inflame domestic public opinion.

**Key Safeguard 4: Costed Withdrawal.** Any party may withdraw through a six-month notification window, orderly asset disposition, infrastructure handover to host states, and personnel repatriation. Nuclear constraints survive withdrawal as residual obligations.

**Key Safeguard 5: Fuel Supply Guarantee Survival.** If the US triggers sanctions snapback on non-nuclear grounds, the fuel supply guarantee remains in force unless the JIG determines a nuclear material breach.

**Key Safeguard 6: Non-Recognition.** Participation in this Accord does not equal diplomatic recognition or alliance. The US and Iran remain adversaries in many domains.

**Key Safeguard 7: Succession Resilience.** The Accord binds institutions, not individuals. Changes of government activate continuity provisions rather than voiding the framework.

# Section 11: Crisis Management

The Accord operates in an environment where incidents will occur. The de-escalation architecture is designed to absorb incidents without triggering reflexive escalation.

## The 24-Hour Cooling-Off Rule

When an incident occurs, no escalatory action by either party may be taken within the first 24 hours. The window is used for Pakistani guarantor backchannel review, fact-gathering by JHA observation assets, and discrepancy assessment. Self-defense rights are preserved where an active armed attack is in progress.

## Five Independent De-Escalation Pathways

Table 20: De-Escalation Pathways

| Pathway                         | Trigger                                                                                              | Duration                  | Authority                                                      |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Crisis Lock                     | 10+ fatalities; verified direct military clash; critical infrastructure attack; IAEA integrity alert | 14 days; extendable to 42 | JIG majority activation; Pakistan facilitates                  |
| Third-Party Spoiler Attribution | Third-party attack or spoiler activity                                                               | 30-day investigation      | JIG-convened attribution panel; neutral technical expert chair |
| Military Deconfliction Hotline  | Any military incident in or near IHTA corridor                                                       | Permanent 24/7            | Oman-hosted; 2-hour mandatory response                         |
| Regional Incident Firewall      | Third-party regional escalation threatening framework                                                | Immediate                 | JIG emergency session; Pakistan facilitates                    |
| Direct Executive Link           | Imminent crisis requiring head-of-state communication                                                | 6-hour consultation       | Pakistan Prime Minister as initial relay                       |

## Maritime De-Escalation Protocols

- **Maritime Incident Hotline:** 24/7 Omani-hosted hotline linking IRGC-Navy, US Fifth Fleet, Iranian Navy, and JHA Maritime Coordination Cell. 2-hour mandatory response window.

- **Vessel Harassment Parameters:** Approach within 100 meters at speed; illumination with targeting radar; simulated attack maneuvers. Any harassment triggers immediate hotline and 24-hour JIG notification.
- **No-Seizure Zone:** Commercial vessels in IHTA corridor international waters may not be seized by any party without prior JHA notification.
- **Lane Separation:** Three lanes separated by 5-nautical-mile buffers. Speed limit 15 knots.
- **Carrier Transit Notification:** US carrier-group transits occur only during pre-announced 48-hour windows. Iranian Navy may observe from beyond 20 nm but may not intercept.

# Section 12: Implementation Roadmap

## Pre-Signature Phase (T-5 Days to T-0)

Table 21: Pre-Signature Checklist

| Day | Action                                                                                               | Responsible         |
|-----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| T-5 | Both governments confirm agreement to proceed; designate senior officials for coordination           | Heads of Government |
| T-4 | Omani Foreign Ministry confirms Muscat facilities ready; JHA provisional charter drafted             | Oman                |
| T-3 | Swiss financial channel confirms escrow architecture; IAEA confirms Oman custody facility readiness  | Switzerland / IAEA  |
| T-2 | Pakistani guarantor confirms mediation team deployment; UN Special Envoy confirms readiness          | Pakistan / UN       |
| T-1 | Both governments issue internal instructions to military commands for ceasefire compliance           | Military Commands   |
| T-0 | Signature ceremony (Muscat or Geneva); ceasefire effective 0000 GMT next day; 14-point MoU operative | Foreign Ministers   |

## Operational Costs and Funding

Table 22: Estimated First-Year Costs

| Item                                          | Estimated Cost             | Funding Source                                |
|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| JHA/IHTA Secretariat (Muscat)                 | \$12M                      | IHTA toll revenues                            |
| Maritime Coordination Cell (Khasab)           | \$4M                       | IHTA toll revenues                            |
| IAEA Oman custody facility operations         | \$8M                       | IAEA regular budget + voluntary contributions |
| Mine clearance operations (6-month)           | \$25M                      | International Maritime Safety Fund            |
| Insurance backstop facility                   | \$20B contingent liability | US DFC + Chubb Ltd. + Lloyd's market          |
| Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund (Year 1) | \$200M                     | 40% of IHTA toll revenues                     |

## Critical Success Factors

1. **Speed in Stage One:** The first 14 days must produce visible, irreversible deliverables. Delays in Stage One erode political capital for both governments.
2. **Israeli Coordination:** The single highest-risk scenario is a coordinated Israeli military strike on Iranian nuclear facilities during the 30-day window. The architectural response is to complete the moratorium ratification and HEU export plan as rapidly as feasible and provide Israeli leadership with sufficiently detailed advance briefings.
3. **Domestic Political Protection:** Both governments need immediate, visible wins. The \$250M pilot, Hormuz reopening, and ceasefire must be communicated as achievements on Day 1.
4. **Verification Credibility:** The five-channel verification system must be fully operational by Day 7. Any perception that verification is one-sided will collapse Iranian participation.
5. **30-Day Window Discipline:** The nuclear specifics must be negotiated within the 30-day window. Extensions erode credibility and invite spoiler activity.
6. **Successor Framework Readiness:** By Day 90, the RCSA v3.6, Crescent Compact v1.7, or RAMES v9.1 negotiation framework must be ready to open. The Stability First Enhanced Accord is a bridge, not a destination.

# Appendices

## Appendix A: Complete Sequencing Matrix Quick Reference

**Table 23: 180-Day Sequencing Matrix -- Deferred Sequencing Model**

| Day   | US Moves                                                                                                                                                         | Iran Moves                                                                                                                                                                    | Verification                                                                 |
|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1     | Suspend Project Freedom; cease offensive ops; issue \$250M OFAC license; confirm Sovereign Energy Partnership; <b>open 30-day nuclear window</b>                 | Cease offensive ops; initiate stockpile transfer to IAEA custody; transmit Hezbollah pause; transmit Houthi pause; <b>commit to moratorium framework (specifics deferred)</b> | Pakistan PM + UN Special Envoy + Oman + Switzerland concurrent certification |
| 3     | OFAC humanitarian license issued                                                                                                                                 | First humanitarian-flagged vessel cleared for Hormuz transit                                                                                                                  | Lloyd's List + UN OCHA + JHA                                                 |
| 7     | Lift naval blockade; transition Project Freedom assets to JHA convoy support                                                                                     | Open Hormuz to commercial transit; withdraw IRGC small craft; commence mine-clearing                                                                                          | JHA observation vessels; Lloyd's List; UN OCHA                               |
| 14    | Stage 1 closing certification                                                                                                                                    | Stage 1 closing certification                                                                                                                                                 | Pakistan + Oman + Switzerland concurrent; Stage 2 automatic                  |
| 15-44 | <b>30-DAY DEFERRED WINDOW: Nuclear moratorium specifics; HEU export logistics; underground facility protocols; snap inspections; sanctions relief sequencing</b> |                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                              |
| 15    | Welcome IAEA full redeployment; begin moratorium duration negotiations                                                                                           | Issue IAEA invitation for declared sites; continuous monitoring installed                                                                                                     | IAEA Director General confirms; satellite corroborates                       |
| 20    | OFAC issues aviation safety and specialty export licenses                                                                                                        | Confirm IAEA continuous monitoring operational                                                                                                                                | JIG verification                                                             |
| 30    | First sanctions tranche operative; process second asset tranche                                                                                                  | Declare 3.67% civilian moratorium framework; idle higher-enrichment centrifuges under IAEA seal                                                                               | IAEA continuous monitoring; JIG certification; Congressional notification    |

|     |                                                                                              |                                                                                                     |                                                                |
|-----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| 44  | Process third asset tranche (cumulative 50%); confirm SWIFT reconnection                     | Moratorium ratified; HEU export plan confirmed; host International Medical Isotope Summit framework | JIG closing certification; Stage 3 automatic                   |
| 60  | Commence full sanctions relief tranche                                                       | Fordow conversion begins (Phase A); IHTA Tier 3 tolling                                             | JIG verification                                               |
| 75  | Open Regional Security Dialogue framework                                                    | Confirm willingness to engage in Regional Security Dialogue                                         | JIG facilitation                                               |
| 90  | Confirm permanent IHTA conversion; UN neutral chair appointment                              | Confirm permanent IHTA conversion; first chair rotation                                             | UN Secretary-General + JIG unanimous certification             |
| 120 | Process fourth asset tranche (20%; cumulative 70%); Stage 3 sanctions tranche                | Confirm nuclear moratorium maintenance; IAEA annual review clean                                    | JIG verification; Congressional review window                  |
| 150 | US Department of Energy Section 123 negotiation                                              | Iran formally requests Section 123 negotiation; confirms fuel supply guarantee discussions          | Joint announcement; IAEA confirms fuel bank access             |
| 180 | Process fifth asset tranche (15%; cumulative 85%); comprehensive successor framework opening | Confirm Stage 3 closing compliance; confirm successor framework opening                             | JIG closing certification; 180-day compliance review published |

## Appendix B: Diplomatic Framing Guide

**Table 24: Dual Framing Reference -- Enhanced Accord**

| Element                    | US Framing                                                      | Iranian Framing                                                                     |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 14-Point MoU               | "Framework for ending the war and securing nuclear commitments" | "Path to peace with sovereignty preserved; nuclear details negotiated, not imposed" |
| 30-day deferred window     | "Time to get the nuclear details right"                         | "Space to negotiate as equals, not under bombardment"                               |
| Stockpile transfer to Oman | "Weapons-grade material removed from Iranian territory"         | "Sovereign asset held in trust under international supervision"                     |
| 12-year moratorium         | "12-year moratorium with automatic extension on violation"      | "Time-limited sovereign commitment; NPT rights fully preserved"                     |
| Fordow conversion          | "Most sensitive facility permanently neutralized"               | "Iranian scientists lead world-class medical research center"                       |
| IHTA governance            | "International authority prevents unilateral Iranian closure"   | "Permanent Iranian co-equality replacing US unilateralism"                          |

|                              |                                                                       |                                                                                  |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tolling revenue              | "Revenue channeled to civilian reconstruction, not IRGC"              | "Direct revenue stream from Hormuz co-governance funds national reconstruction"  |
| Asset return tranches        | "Tranche architecture with Congressional oversight"                   | "Irreversible return of sovereign property"                                      |
| SWIFT reconnection           | "Conditional on FATF compliance"                                      | "Banking normalization restoring sovereign fiscal capacity"                      |
| Synchronized lift            | "Iran lifts Hormuz restrictions simultaneously with US blockade lift" | "US lifts blockade simultaneously with Hormuz reopening -- neither moves alone"  |
| Verification                 | "Five-channel verification prevents Iranian cheating"                 | "Multi-source verification ensures no single power controls compliance findings" |
| Sovereign Energy Partnership | "Iran accepted civilian-only nuclear program"                         | "Iran proposed the Sovereign Energy Partnership as a sovereign choice"           |

## Appendix C: Glossary of Key Terms

| Term            | Definition                                                          |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Accord          | This document; the Stability First Enhanced Accord v1.0             |
| Deferred Window | The 30-day period (Days 15-44) for negotiating nuclear specifics    |
| 14-Point MoU    | The one-page Memorandum of Understanding that opens Stage 1         |
| BAP             | Binding Arbitration Panel -- dispute resolution body                |
| CCP             | Commercial Continuity Protocol -- protects private-sector contracts |
| DFC             | US International Development Finance Corporation                    |
| Dual Blockade   | Iranian Hormuz restrictions plus US naval blockade on Iranian ports |
| ESPA            | Emergency Snapback Prevention Authority                             |
| HEU             | Highly Enriched Uranium                                             |
| IHTA            | International Hormuz Transit Authority                              |
| IMIRC           | International Medical Isotope Research Center (Fordow conversion)   |
| JHA             | Joint Hormuz Authority (provisional IHTA)                           |
| JIG             | Joint Implementation Group -- central coordination body             |
| Moratorium      | Period of suspended enrichment above 3.67%                          |
| Project Freedom | US Navy Hormuz escort operation (paused Day 1)                      |



|                              |                                                               |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| RCSA                         | Regional Comprehensive Security Architecture                  |
| Sovereign Energy Partnership | Framework for Iran's civilian nuclear program post-moratorium |

Appendix D: The 30-Day Window Negotiation Agenda

For negotiators working within the 30-day deferred window, the following agenda structure is recommended:

Table 25: 30-Day Window Negotiation Calendar

| Period     | Priority Issues                                                               | Target Outcomes                          |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Days 15-18 | Moratorium duration and terms; violation-extension mechanism                  | Principled agreement on 12-15 year range |
| Days 19-22 | HEU export logistics; destination; transport timeline                         | Confirmed export plan with IAEA          |
| Days 23-26 | Underground facility protocols; Fordow conversion timeline; Natanz parameters | Facility protocols agreed and documented |
| Days 27-30 | Inspections regime; snap inspection scope; Additional Protocol                | Inspection framework ratified            |
| Days 31-36 | Sanctions relief sequencing; asset return tranches; SWIFT reconnection        | Economic package agreed                  |
| Days 37-40 | Integration and review; cross-cutting issues; dispute resolution              | Draft comprehensive package              |
| Days 41-44 | Final ratification; concurrent certification; Stage 2 closing                 | All elements verified and operative      |

Document Certification

This document, the Stability First Enhanced Accord v1.0, reflects the diplomatic breakthrough of May 7-8, 2026, when negotiators transitioned from a failed "Nuclear First" model to a "Nuclear-Deferred" sequencing framework. The 14-point MoU and 30-day deferred window it describes are drawn from confirmed reporting by Axios, The Wall Street Journal, CNN, and multiple official sources. This Accord is offered as the ready-to-implement architecture for that window.

*"Nuclear Deferred. Hormuz Resolved."*